A-A-53885
12 June 1989

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SPATULA, DENTAL, CEMENT (No. 324)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description as a replacement for Federal Specification GG-S-590B, style 324, which is cancelled.

This commercial item description covers a spatula of style 324 for use in mixing zinc phosphate cements.

Salient Characteristics:

Material. The spatula shall be fabricated of class 4, type 420 or class 4, type 440A martensitic corrosion-resisting steel as specified in ASTM F899, for composition only.

Style, design and dimensions. The spatula shall be a single-ended instrument and shall be of one-piece construction, suitable for mixing cements. The spatula blade shall be properly tapered to provide the necessary flexibility for mixing cements. The spatula handle shall be straight. The spatula handle shall be of octagonal shape, and shall either be smooth or have fillet type serrations. One face of the serrated handle shall be left smooth for identification markings. The style, design and dimensions of the spatula shall conform to Defense Personnel Support Center (DPSC) Drawing 20444.

Hardness. After proper stress relieving, the Rockwell hardness of the operative end (blade) shall be between C40 and C50 inclusive for instruments fabricated from type 420 steel, and between C52 and C56 inclusive for instruments fabricated from type 440A steel. Handles and shanks shall have a minimum Rockwell hardness of C20.

Corrosion-resistance. In accordance with ASTM F1089, the spatula shall meet the requirements of the resistance to copper sulfate test and the resistance to boil test when tested as specified herein.

Finish. The operative end of each spatula shall have a finish such that when the cement is mixed, it shall not permanently adhere to the spatula. The shank and operative end of each spatula shall have a mirror finish. Smooth spatula handles shall have a bright polished finish.

AMSC N/A FSC 6520

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A: Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Identification marking. The spatula shall be permanently and legibly marked as specified herein. All markings shall be on the smooth face of the spatula handle. The word "stainless" shall be marked on instruments of foreign manufacture. As an alternate to the word "stainless," the use of a registered trade name identifying the steel as stainless shall be acceptable, provided prior approval is received from the cognizant contracting officer. Spatulas of foreign manufacture shall bear the name of the country of origin.

Workmanship. The spatula shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability, proper functioning, or intended use.

Unit. Each (EA). One spatula, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the material, may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Quality conformance inspection. The examinations and tests required to assure conformance of those items or lots of items to be offered are classified as specified herein.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an inspection level II, except the dimensions shall be conducted at inspection level S-1, with an AQL of 2.5 (percent defective). The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one spatula.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted and as specified herein. The acceptance number shall be zero (0) for all sample sizes. Where feasible, the same sample unit shall be used for the determination of two or more tests characteristics. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one spatula. Lots for hardness testing shall be as specified herein.

Tests.

Component	Characteristics	Inspection level
Operative end	Hardness	S-2
Entire Instrument	Copper Sulfate	S-2
Entire Instrument	Boil Test	S-2

Sampling of raw materials. A sufficient amount from each lot of each metal used in the fabrication of the spatulas shall be selected for chemical analysis.

Examination. The spatula shall be examined to determine compliance with specification requirements. Examination shall be conducted in accordance as specified herein. The spatula shall be examined for defects, including but not limited to, those listed below.

Defects

Style and design not as specified for style 324.
Finish on operative ends not as specified.
Operative ends not free of coarse grind marks or other imperfections.
Operative ends bent.
Dimensions not as specified.
Serrations incomplete or not as specified.
Handles not straight.
Finish on handles and shanks not as specified.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Defects (continued)

Instrument identifications not present, not legible, not permanent, or improperly located.
Instrument not free from dirt, oil, polishing compound, or foreign matter.
Instruments not permanently and legibly marked with name or trademark of manufacturer.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

Hardness. Hardness shall be determined in accordance with ASTM Designation E18 (Rockwell) or E92 (Vickers or Diamond Pyramid).

Corrosion test.

Copper sulfate test. The copper sulfate test shall be conducted in accordance with ASTM F1089.

Boil test. The boil test shall be conducted in accordance with ASTM F1089.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch/pounds units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met. If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerance specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine of the product is acceptable. The contracting officer has the option if accepting or rejecting the product.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

National Stock Number	Item Identification
6520-00-556-8000	Spatula, Dental, Cement (No. 324)

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be as specified in the contract and/or order.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army-MD
Navy-MS
Air Force-03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

A-A-53885

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

48173

PROJECT NUMBER: 6520-2234

LOCATION: NCR DISK 1

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

DD FORM 82 MAR 1428

PREVIOUS EDITION IS OBSOLETE.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS: In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use in submitting comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide suggestions. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAPLE)*, and mailed. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out, an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE. This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

NO POSTAGE NECESSARY IF MAILED IN THE UNITED STATES

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO 4066 WASHINGTON D C

POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY THE DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

Commander
Defense Personnel Support Center
Attn: DPSC-RSTE
2800 South 20th Street
Philadelphia, PA 19101

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.